

Welcome to Zillow Preferred

57 minutes including practice · 34 screens

Edition 2026-09-13-preferred-foundations-v3

Practice notes

Use fictional details. Written opinions are ungraded: explain your thinking, including uncertainty. You can continue without a correction or a keyword. Save and check the hands-on record actions separately. During a live session, submit through your own login; this printable worksheet is a backup and does not submit for you. Unfinished work remains available when the presenter advances.

Follow Up Boss practice

Stay in the assigned TrueHQ session for the whole class. Every learner uses their own login and simulated record. The People list is a reference image: review the controls and submit a navigation explanation here. The simulator opens inside a contact; no separate Follow Up Boss account or training pond is needed. This walkthrough does not verify hands-on search. Arrange any coach-observed search check separately after class. Preserve the repair diagnosis step.

Coach where to click, save, and verify. The server check validates saved actions; it does not judge note usefulness. After a passed record changes, check it again. Each exercise is a separate scenario. Give everyone a first attempt and use the discussion to explore reasoning; do not stretch the lesson to fill a clock.

Choose the tool

Where	Use it for	When
Details -> Stage / Timeframe	Actual progress / buyer's stated timing	After a meaningful conversation or event; review automatic changes.
Create Note -> contact history	Facts, preferences, outcome and unknowns	Read before outreach; save context after it.
Right -> Tasks	Work owed, with an owner and due date	When you promise a callback or another next action.
Right -> Appointments	A confirmed meeting	When date, time and participants are agreed; check duplicates.
Right -> Files	Relevant approved documents	When needed under the team's document process.
Right -> Deals	Transaction details	At the team's transaction milestone; today's case is an accepted offer.
Right -> Collaborators	Team member access	When someone helps; also give them a task and handoff.
Relationships	A co-buyer or related contact	When relevant to the customer; not team access.
Right -> Action Plans / Automations	Existing system workflows	Check prior messages before personal outreach; team manages setup.
Left -> My Agent; right -> Zillow Insights	Relationship status and eligible browsing context	Before personalized outreach; confirm rather than assume.
Top -> Inbox / Tasks / Calendar	Conversations / commitments / scheduled events	Start-of-day review, then update as work happens.

Choose capacity you can actually serve

Coverage and capacity

Sam has six active buyers, two evening showing blocks, and a day job on Tuesdays. Sam knows Olympia and Lacey well, but is considering distant ZIPs to receive more leads. Sam wants 20 new connections per month and assumes Zillow will deliver exactly 20.

Sam can answer calls during several daytime windows, but has no coverage arranged for Tuesday. Think about driving time, first conversations, showings, and weeks of follow-up - not just how many new names fit in a list.

What would you change or clarify with Sam about ZIPs, availability, and monthly capacity?

Explain how you would find Avery

A name is a starting point, not an identity check

You are covering for Alex Rivera. A message says: “Avery wants to compare 406 and 422 Juniper.” You have a name and two property addresses, but you have not spoken with Avery yourself.

The People reference shows Avery Morgan assigned to Alex. The source under the name reads “Training Source” because this is a fictional training image. In a real record, Source tells you where the contact came from; Assigned to tells you who owns the follow-up. Do not assume a record says Zillow just because this is a Zillow class.

Your task is to explain where you would start and which details you would compare before changing anything. If two people had the same first name, what would stop you from editing the wrong person? You do not need to perform a search outside this session.

Explain how you would identify the right Avery before editing. Use the reference and the covering-agent scenario.

Where would you start, which details would you compare, and what would you do if the name alone did not identify the right person?

Practice: save the appointment stage

Work in the simulated record below. Save your changes, then check your work here.

Complete the simulated record exercise in your own TrueHQ session. Save, reopen, and verify. Check your work here to submit the live-session result. Each exercise is a separate fictional case. Bring missing actions or an unclear control to your coach.

Review the update before moving on

“Friday could work” is not a confirmed meeting

Jamie says Friday afternoon might work, but needs to check with a partner. No time or property is agreed. A Smart Actions message suggests an appointment for Friday at 3. You also notice the move timeframe changed.

You still owe Jamie a call tomorrow. Inspect the proposed action and the actual conversation. Decide what to accept, decline, or correct, and what work remains yours.

What would you do with the suggestion, the changed timeframe, and tomorrow’s follow-up?

Turn browsing signals into a better question

A change worth asking about

Last Tuesday, Taylor said a three-bedroom home near work mattered most, but had not settled on a budget. Today, eligible Zillow activity shows saved homes in another ZIP and a higher price range.

You have no new reply from Taylor. A partner might be browsing, or the criteria might have changed. You do not know yet.

Look at the date range and the actual saved/viewed homes. Offer a useful comparison and ask whether the search has changed. Treat the price range as browsing context, not approved purchasing power.

Write one useful outreach question for Taylor and identify one assumption you would avoid.

Practice: write the conversation note

Work in the simulated record below. Save your changes, then check your work here.

Complete the simulated record exercise in your own TrueHQ session. Save, reopen, and verify. Check your work here to submit the live-session result. Each exercise is a separate fictional case. Bring missing actions or an unclear control to your coach.

One conversation can need several tools

A covering agent needs a usable handoff

Avery agrees to tour 406 Juniper on Saturday at 11. You promised to check parking with the listing agent tomorrow. A teammate will cover the showing and needs access to Avery's background. Avery's sister is a co-buyer, not a member of your team. You also received a relevant approved document.

You need to preserve the buyer's preferences, record the meeting, assign your parking follow-up, and prepare the covering agent. No offer has been accepted.

Where would you put each part of the handoff, and what would you leave for later?

Practice: set the missed-call task

Work in the simulated record below. Save your changes, then check your work here.

Complete the simulated record exercise in your own TrueHQ session. Save, reopen, and verify. Check your work here to submit the live-session result. Each exercise is a separate fictional case. Bring missing actions or an unclear control to your coach.

Define nurture: two different decisions

Maya Chen · The move is later, but there is a promise due

How it started: Maya requested a tour through Zillow three weeks ago. You spoke and toured one home together. She is renting until March and said, “I probably won’t move before my lease ends, but I want to understand the neighborhoods before I choose.”

What happened this week: On Tuesday she sent two listings and asked which area would make the commute easier. You agreed to call Friday at 4 p.m. She replied, “Yes, talk then.” She has not asked to stop hearing from you, and no second showing is booked.

What you inherit: The stage is Met with customer. A Friday 4 p.m. call task is assigned to you. A covering agent added, “Six months out - move to Nurture?” You have not discussed how often Maya wants contact or whether she would consider a suitable home sooner.

The decision: It is Friday at 3:45 p.m. Would you change the stage now, keep it while you clarify something, or take another step? What would you ask on the agreed call? Explain how your plan respects her timing and the promise already made.

Jordan Ellis · The record is quiet, but look at the attempts

How it started: Jordan requested information about 18 Cedar Street through Zillow on Monday morning. You called that morning, reached voicemail, and left a message offering to arrange a showing. You have never spoken with Jordan.

What happened this week: An automatic welcome text went out Monday. On Wednesday you personally texted, “I can help arrange a visit to Cedar Street - would Thursday afternoon or Saturday morning work?” There has been no reply. The record shows two property views on Thursday; it does not explain why Jordan viewed them.

What you inherit: It is Friday. The stage is Attempted contact. There is no next task. Another agent wrote, “No response - maybe not serious. Nurture?” The history contains one personal call and one personal text; the automatic message is separate.

The decision: What can you fairly conclude about Jordan’s interest? What would you do before treating this as a longer-term relationship? Choose a next attempt that offers a reason to respond, and explain when you would review the result. You do not know whether Jordan is busy, already helped, or no longer looking.

For Maya and Jordan, separate what you know from what you are assuming. Explain the next action you would take and why.

For each buyer, what do you know from the record, what is still unknown, and would you change the stage yet? Explain your reasoning.

What would you do next for each buyer? Include what you would say or ask, who owns the action, and when you would do it.

What new information would make you change your plan? Name a specific answer or event, and when you would review the record.

Practice: repair Avery's record

Work in the simulated record below. Save your changes, then check your work here.

Complete the simulated record exercise in your own TrueHQ session. Save, reopen, and verify. Check your work here to submit the live-session result. Each exercise is a separate fictional case. Bring missing actions or an unclear control to your coach.

Practice: record the accepted offer

Work in the simulated record below. Save your changes, then check your work here.

Complete the simulated record exercise in your own TrueHQ session. Save, reopen, and verify. Check your work here to submit the live-session result. Each exercise is a separate fictional case. Bring missing actions or an unclear control to your coach.

Where will you start tomorrow?

Your first five minutes back at work

You open the task list and see a promised buyer call due in ten minutes, a new inquiry with no attempt logged, and an older record whose note says only "follow up." A colleague can help, but needs to know what to do.

Explain how you would organize these actions without letting one vanish. You may ask for missing information. There is no single required order: state what you would check, what you would act on, and how you would make responsibility clear.

Plan the next actions for the three records. Explain your priorities and what you would need to check.

What would you handle first, what would you check or delegate, and what belongs in each record so nothing is lost?

Before your next client conversation

Make the record update part of finishing the conversation.

After my next call, I will complete ____ before moving on.

My next follow-up block starts in ____.

My named coach and the example we will review.

Leave with a clear readiness check

What is ready, what remains uncertain, and who will help you resolve it before leads begin?

What each signal means

Connection status is separate from participation. A submitted answer is separate from a completed action. A record check is separate from writing quality. Record who observed a speaking turn and who reviewed it; a peer observation or self-check is not coach sign-off. Practice readiness, quiz certification, and activation remain separate.

After the workshop

Live session: closing the session creates assignments for recall within 24 hours, a fresh case in three days, and coach review in seven days. The session creator owns follow-up across the selected teams unless a different authorized coach was selected. Confirm the displayed session timezone. Due and overdue work appears in Rep; the daily digest links to work due or awaiting review.

Self-paced study: arrange those same checks with a coach. If there has been no relevant client opportunity, use a new fictional case and mark real-work application as not yet observed.

Keep the first attempt and correction. A useful follow-up asks whether the agent can apply the skill in another case.

References

- Zillow Preferred FAQ - official reference, reviewed 2026-09-13
- Zillow Preferred Program Standards - official reference, reviewed 2026-09-13
- Agent Capacity and Lead Routing - official reference, reviewed 2026-09-13
- Zillow Preferred Program Benefits - official reference, reviewed 2026-09-13
- Zillow Preferred Compliance Policies - official reference, reviewed 2026-09-13
- Smart Actions - official reference, reviewed 2026-09-13
- My Agent Status - official reference, reviewed 2026-09-13
- Zillow Insights in Follow Up Boss - official reference, reviewed 2026-09-13
- Lead Profile Overview - official reference, reviewed 2026-09-13
- Inbox Overview - official reference, reviewed 2026-09-13
- Smart Lists Overview - official reference, reviewed 2026-09-13
- Tasks Overview - official reference, reviewed 2026-09-13
- Connecting Your Email & Calendar - official reference, reviewed 2026-09-13
- Zillow Preferred Agent Performance Report - official reference, reviewed 2026-09-13
- Action Plans Overview - official reference, reviewed 2026-09-13
- Zillow Touring Agreement - official reference, reviewed 2026-09-13